Task 2

Figure 1: European Heatwave Graphed

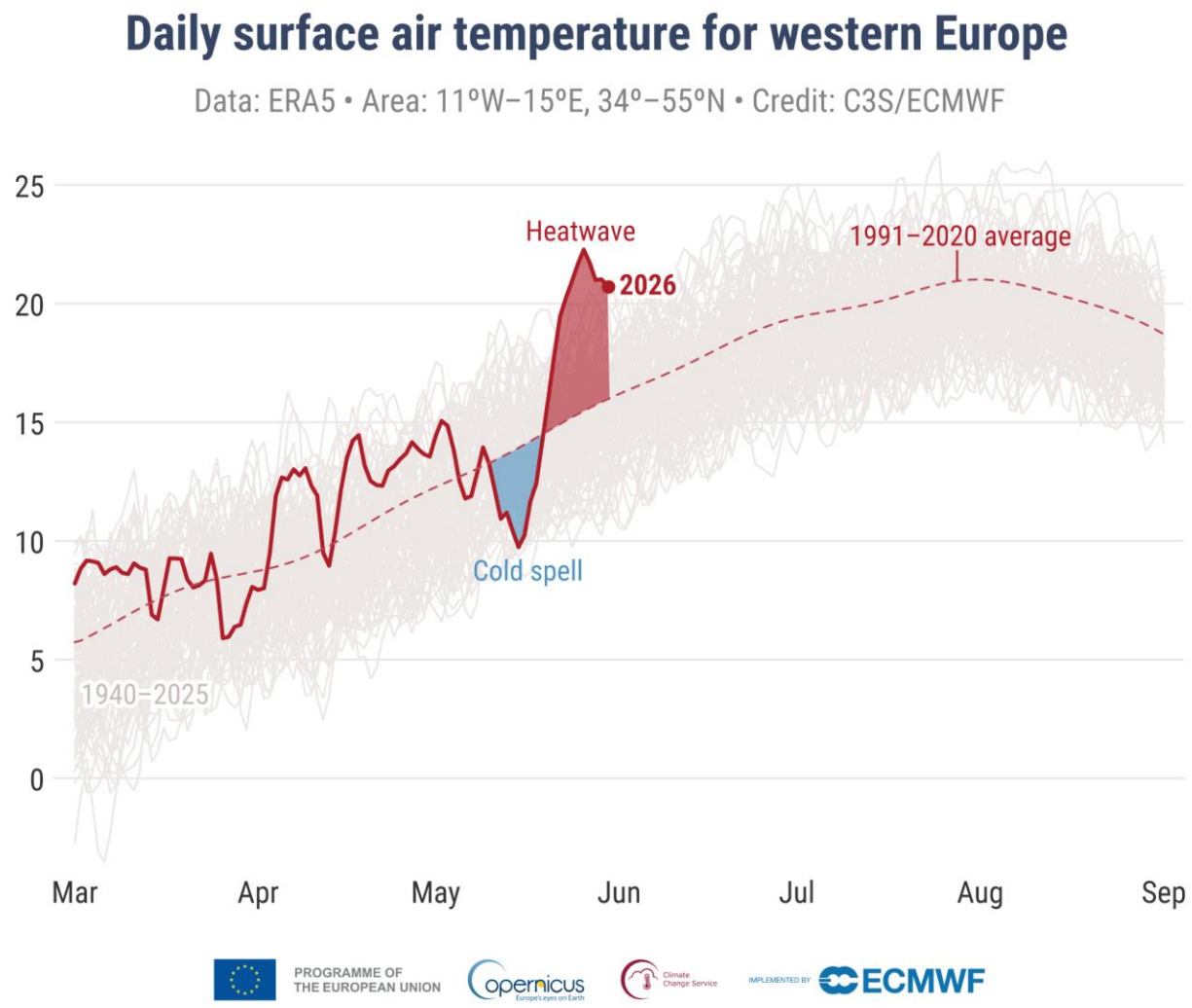


Image Credit: https://climate.copernicus.eu/what-do-we-know-about-europes-early-and-intense-heatwave-may-2026

What it shows:

The graph shows the summer temperatures daily in Western Europe in degrees Celsius, comparing it to the average of temperatures between 1991 and 2025 with the temperatures of years 1940 to 2025 in the background.

The Data's Source:

The data is from Copernicus' ERA5 Data Store, a European-centric data store tracking weather and temperature conditions. The data's exact location source is at the top of the graph.

My Opinion:

The graph very clearly visually lays out the summer average and the anomalous data from summer 2026 differently, allowing very easy visual comparison. It also labels the anomalies and what they are called in the "Cold Spell" and "Heatwave" notations. The background of the graph also shows all previous summers graphs, giving a good visual indicator of the temperature variation and previous anomalous summers. The graph however does not label the measures of the axis and could further include an average of all temperatures since 1940.